

"Mystery meat" takes on a whole new meaning

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In case you didn't hear, the big news in the food industry this week is the fact that — gasp — horsemeat has been **detected** in Burger King burgers and Ikea's Swedish meatballs. **Noses** worldwide are **turning up** in disgust **at**¹ the use of such **crude**² **ingredients** in ground beef products.

1. Turn up one's nose at something: to show contempt or disdain or distaste
2. Crude means inferior or coarse here. 表示劣质的, 粗制的; crude 还可以用来形容 humour. O Henry's humour was crude. 欧亨利的漫画是粗鄙露骨, 不堪入目的。

There's no doubt that a good part of the **fuss**³ is that, for some of the Western world, horsemeat is **taboo**. Many people have an immediate, visceral reaction to the **notion** of eating horse, just like Americans generally **react strongly to**(对某事反应激烈) the idea of eating dogs. While our preferences are culturally **rooted**, the recent labeling **exposures**⁴ don't just **offend** our palates⁵. As consumers, we rely on retailers and restaurants to give us accurate information about which foods we are buying — whether it be to avoid **allergies**, follow religious preferences, choose more **sustainable** options, or **count calories**. Now, DNA barcoding is **exposing** just how often we are **duped**.

3. Fuss means needless excitement or bustle and hustle 无端的激动或喧哗 or a state of agitation especially over a trivial matter 或表示对芝麻大点儿事情产生的骚动。E.g. What a fuss about nothing! 总是一惊一乍的, 才多大点儿事!
4. Exposure means the act of exposing or revealing 表示揭露不好的或见不得光的事情
5. Offend means to cause anger, displeasure or dissatisfaction 表示冒犯, 使人不悦。这里 offend the palates 冒犯了我们的上颚, 即我们的味觉, 我们可以理解成: 让我们吃起来觉得恶心。
6. Dupe has many synonyms, like cheat, deceive, fool 都表示被骗。

Labeling isn't a European problem. In South Africa, game is a popular **alternative** to beef, with over 2.5 million hectares of land **dedicated to** farming(**be dedicated to doing** 被用于做某事) a wide variety of wild meats. But a study published in Investigative Genetics today found that more than 3/4 of the game **samples** they tested were not the animal they said they were. Cuts labeled as wild game species were **identified**(被识别为) as horse, kangaroo, pork, lamb, and a suite of African animals not on the labels. The most **prevalent substitution**⁷ occurred for products labeled kudu (92% were mislabeled). A different South African study tells a similar story. A study of beef products in South Africa published earlier this week found that 68% of samples contained species not **declared**(=claimed) in the product label, including donkey, buffalo, goat and pork, and almost a third of the products contained soy and gluten, even though the labels didn't tell the consumer that. But, they didn't find any horsemeat in their beef.

7. Substitution 在原文中也有其他近义词, 如该段第二句的 "...game is a popular **alternative** to beef..."

In the US, studies have found that more than 1/3 of all US fish are mislabeled. A recent

Oceana report found that 39% of fish sold in NY grocery stores, fish markets and sushi restaurants were not the fish they claimed to be, building on their earlier findings of in Boston (48%), Los Angeles (55%), and Miami (31%). Every single one of the 16 sushi restaurants tested sold mislabeled fish. Some species were substituted more often — 69% of the tuna sold wasn't tuna, and thirteen different species were sold **falsely** under the label “red snapper”⁹. But perhaps the worst part was that 94% of white tuna sold was actually escolar, a fish species known to cause poisoning. While the world is **fretting about**(to feel anxious about 为……担忧) horses, I'd rather eat a little horsemeat than diarrhea-inducing escolar any day.⁸

8. While the world is still being disturbed by the horse meat, I would rather eat horse meat than poisonous escolar.这句话充满嘲讽。

9. 作者使用的双引号“red snapper”有几层含义，但最重要的意义依旧是 To signal or lay stress on short titles, 强调短称谓。作者此处用双引号来强调红鲷鱼这个鱼种经常被假冒，买家一定要小心了！当然，还有一层微弱的讽刺语气，即黑心商家居然用低劣的鱼肉来冒充鲷鱼！

Why does it seem so hard for the world to correctly label the species in our stores? Part of the problem is that there is high economic **incentive** to lie. Species that are worth top dollar are particularly **lucrative**¹⁰ to **forge**¹¹. Until now, exposing such **fraud** has been difficult, as many species look the same once they're **ground**(grind, ground, ground 表示磨碎), cut or filleted. But now, we can test foods on the genetic level, allowing us to **identify** all species present. Given these **frauds**(欺骗，诈骗) have real financial, religious, **ethical** and public health **ramifications**¹², **it seems past time**¹³ that genetic testing become a **constant** part of the **regulatory**¹⁴ process.

10. Lucrative: capable of producing a great deal of benefit. 油水多的，高利润回报的。

11. Forge means to counterfeit, to imitate, to make something dishonestly that only looks like the same in appearance.表示仿造，伪造。

12. Ramifications 这个单词往往一定要加复数“s”才能表示 bad results, bad consequences 不良的结果。同学们只记这一个含义即可：(复数)表示不良后果。

13. 同学们务必注意，这里是 it seems **past time**... 而不是 **it seems pastime, it seems pass time**...这两种表达法都是错误的。It seems past time that...这是一个固定搭配，怎么理解呢？past time 表示时间早就过去了，早该完成了！所以，原句的意思是 Genetic testing is long overdue.(早该完成了) The government should have put into force the genetic testing sooner! 政府应该早点儿实施基因检测（不该等到事件产生了才行动）。

14. Regulatory is the adjective of regulate. Regulate means to control by rules, laws and regulations. (Regulation is the noun form, regulate is the verb form, regulatory is the adjective form.)制度化的，规范化的，按照管理规定执行的

Actually **enacting**¹⁵ such legislation, however, has proven difficult. In the UK, the Food Standards Authority was quick to commission genetic testing after **the scandal hit**¹⁶, but beforehand, testing had been **declining** for years. In the US, the USDA only genetically tests meat when there is a reason to **suspect** horseplay. And despite our clear fish labeling problem, no action was taken when the Safety And Fraud Enforcement for Seafood (SAFE Seafood) Act was introduced last year. If we want to improve labeling, we need to push our governments and tell them that genetic testing is non-negotiable.

15. Enact means to put into force, to implement, to carry out. 表示执行。

16. Hit means critical remarks. 表示批判的言辞, 所以 the scandal hit 大家可以理解成: the angry reproaches about the food scandal 食物丑闻爆出后的舆论哗然。此外, 我们还有其他的各种 hit, 如 gossip hit, 绯闻引起的舆论不满; 如 misbehaviour hit, 不当行为产生的舆论不满等等。

Perhaps, though, it is also time to look inward and reflect on(后面一定要接 on/upon 才表示反思, 思考) our own cultural biases. What makes a cow so much better to eat than a horse, anyway? Why not make burgers out of insects? In a world where fishery after fishery collapses(=go bankrupt 破产, 倒闭) under our demand and livestock threatens our land, air and water resources, perhaps we need to diversify¹⁷ our idea of what is fit for our plates, and ultimately(=eventually, at last) seek to minimize our ecological footprint by any food necessary.¹⁸ If there is anything that our labeling failures have exposed, it is the need to closely examine the animals we consume and the ways we catch or farm them to determine the best ones for us, both in terms of¹⁹ nutrition and by measures of sustainability.

17. Diversify means to vary; diverse means various; diversity means variety.

18. The sentence can be paraphrased in this way: It is time to reduce the impact of human beings' eating activities on our environment by reflecting on what are suitable for us to eat. Or (同学们用 **中观的** 角度, 将该句和这一段的第一句中心句结合起来。那么, 作者是不是在给出如何应对 cultural biases 带来的困难?) to put it in a much much simpler way: We need to abandon our cultural biases and diversify our food choices. 我们应该摒弃文化偏见, 并尽可能多样化食物。

19. In terms of, 注意不是 **in term of**, 这个短语一定有一个 s, 才表示“关于”, “在某些方面”; 和 with regard to 语义相同, 但不是 **with regards to**...同学词汇的记忆一定要非常准确。哪些有 s, 那些没有 s, 要准确记忆。